bide her time and come to know this new world before she could figure out how to fight it.

After they left the room and waited outside in the cold for their *Arbeitsbuch für Ausländer*—the foreigners' permit to reside and work in Germany—to be delivered, she vowed to help those poor women who had their dignity and rights stripped from them so that the men in power could run the engine of their war.

"Here," Lagerführer Klein said, handing them their *Arbeitsbuch* cards a short while later. "Carry them on you always. You'll need to show it to the guard for permission to enter the factory, or to use your meal coupons and purchase any items in shops with ration cards. Do not lose them."

The sisters nodded.

"I will now take you to the camp."

Léa breathed in the air, grateful to be away from what she'd seen inside. They walked along a stream, which must be a tributary from the river the train had followed because it was narrower and shallow enough that the pale brown stones under the water reflected the muted afternoon light. A gray sky and metallic smell hung in the air. Clouds rose from the factory furnaces, churning out rings of black smoke.

At last, they passed through a wrought-iron gate into a large compound, where a building was surrounded by tall evergreen trees. A man emerged from a guardhouse near the gate and conversed with Lagerführer Klein, who instructed the sisters to show him their work cards. He wrote their names down in a large book. Then, they proceeded to the building set back from the gate.

"Is this where we're going to live?" Rose whispered, pointing at the massive gray brick structure looming over the compound.

"Yes," Lagerführer Klein said. "Before the war, it was a factory. It's now been converted into a dormitory for foreign workers."

A group of women came down the stairs. Léa noticed they all seemed to be wearing a patch sewn onto the upper right side of their aprons—a yellow square with a purple border and in the middle of the square, a large purple P.

Lagerführer Klein stopped halfway up the stairs, her mouth pinching, as the three women descended. "Halt," she ordered, pointing a finger at one of the women, who seemed the youngest of the group. "*Komm*," she